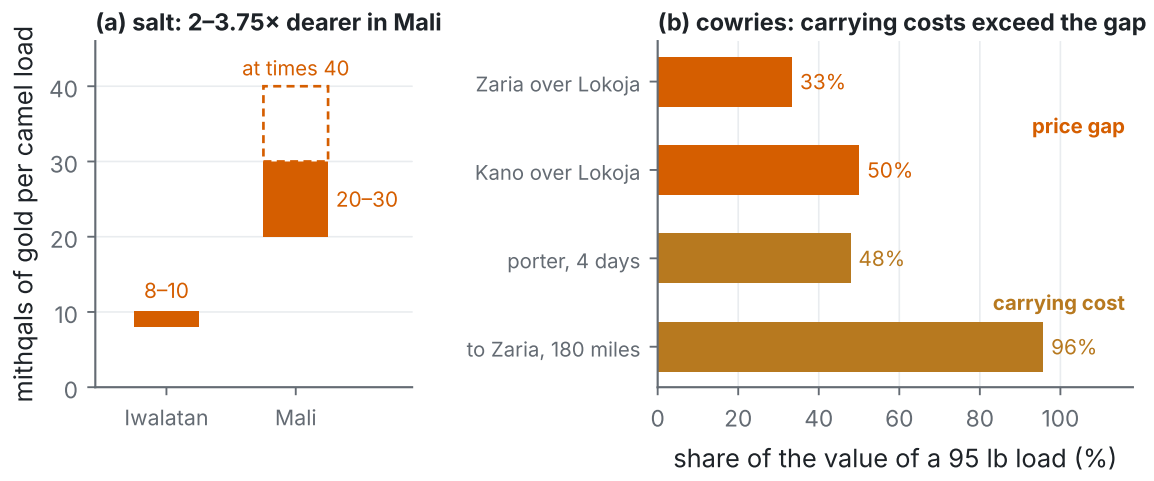
(a) salt: 2–3.75× dearer in Mali
mithqals of gold per camel load
0
10
20
30
40
8–10
20–30
at times 40
Iwalatan
Mali
(b) cowries: carrying costs exceed the gap
Zaria over Lokoja
33%
price gap
Kano over Lokoja
50%
porter, 4 days
48%
carrying cost
to Zaria, 180 miles
96%
0
20
40
60
80
100
share of the value of a 95 lb load (%)